

Beards, stubble, and the eyebrow line

Week 8 Lecture 1 , Looksmaxxing

Autumn 2026

What we'll cover

- Why patchy beards in your early 20s are not a verdict
- Stubble length progression: what happens week by week
- Cheek lines and neck lines: placement, not decoration
- Matching beard shape to face shape
- Eyebrow tidying without overplucking
- Which tool goes where: razor vs trimmer

Beard genetics and patience

Patchy in your early 20s

- Beard density is largely controlled by androgen receptor sensitivity in follicles, not testosterone level
- Terminal density increases through roughly age 25-28 for many men
- Patchy at 20 does not mean patchy at 27 for everyone, but it is not guaranteed to fill in
- If you are 28 and still patchy, that is your beard: work with it, not against it
- No supplement, oil, or dermaroller protocol has strong evidence for beard growth
- Honest baseline: wait, track annually, and choose a style that works at current density

Stubble length by week

Stubble does not feel or look the same at every length. Each stage has a different social read.

Stage	Length	Character
Coarse sandpaper	0.5-1 mm	Scratchy, looks unkempt unless lines are clean
Heavy shadow	1-3 mm	Clean and intentional if well edged
Short stubble	3-5 mm	Most forgiving: hides patchy areas, reads groomed
Medium stubble	5-8 mm	Starts reading as beard; commitment required
Short beard	10+ mm	Requires consistent line maintenance

Short stubble (3-5 mm) is the most forgiving length for patchy beards because it creates visual density even where follicle coverage is uneven.

Lines: cheek and neck

The cheek line

- The natural cheek line is where your beard hair meets clear skin when you look straight ahead
- A hard shaved cheek line above the natural growth line reads as artificial: most faces benefit from a low, natural fade instead
- Exception: thick, coarse beards where the natural line is visually heavy benefit from a clean edge 1-2 mm below the natural boundary
- Rule of thumb: if you are holding a razor and asking yourself how high to go, go lower than your instinct says

Source: Matty Conrad / GQ, 2024 , beard shapes matched to face structure.

The neck line: the single most common mistake

- Place two fingers horizontally above your Adam's apple
- The bottom of the beard should meet skin there
- Too high: the beard becomes a floating chin strap
- Too low: neckbeard
- The neck line should follow a gentle curve from ear to ear passing through that two-finger point, not a straight horizontal cut

Matty Conrad (GQ, 2024): "The neckline is where most men make their first and biggest beard mistake , they take it too high."

Beard shape by face shape

The goal: create the illusion of an oval

Every face-shape rule in grooming has one aim: approximate an oval face, because oval proportions read as balanced across the widest range of observers.

Face shape	What the beard should do
Round	Add length at the chin, reduce width at the cheeks
Oblong / long	Add width at the sides, keep chin length short
Square	Soften the jawline with a rounded base
Heart	Add width at the jaw, keep the chin natural
Diamond	Balance width at chin and temples

Source: Matty Conrad / GQ, 2024 , the goal of a face-shape-matched cut is to create the illusion of an oval face.

Stubble on a patchy beard

- A patchy beard looks worse longer: longer growth shows gaps between follicle clusters
- Short stubble (3-5 mm) with a clean neck line is more controlled than a sparse 10 mm beard
- The face-shape rules still apply at stubble length: a round face should not let the sideburns flare wide even at 4 mm
- If growth is too uneven to look intentional at any length, a clean shave is a valid and confident choice

Eyebrows

The masculine eyebrow principle

- Men's eyebrows are thicker and less arched than women's: that is the correct target
- The natural arch is almost always the right arch: do not reshape it
- Work beneath the brow to remove stray hairs
- Trim long hairs that cross the brow line using a spoolie and small scissors
- Remove unibrow hairs with tweezers: one at a time, not a session of bulk plucking
- Never pluck above the brow unless a hair is wildly isolated

Source: Professional barber tutorial (2025) , "For men, work beneath the brow to remove stray hairs and trim length , never reshape the top arch."

What overplucking looks like

- Dramatic arch: looks feminine and takes months to grow back
- Thin brow: reads as over-groomed and draws attention to itself
- Asymmetry from too much done on one side
- The question to ask before each tweezer use: is this hair clearly outside the natural brow shape?
- If unsure, leave it

Tool selection for eyebrows

- **Spoolie brush:** brush hairs upward before trimming to reveal which ones exceed the brow line
- **Small grooming scissors:** trim, do not pluck, for long hairs
- **Tweezers:** unibrow hairs and clear strays only
- **Razor or trimmer:** do not use on eyebrows unless you have practiced on others first

Razor vs trimmer

The right tool for each job

Job	Tool	Why
Clean shave	Cartridge or safety razor	Closer to skin than any trimmer
Neck line edge	Trimmer with detail attachment	More control than razor on curved surface
Cheek line edge	Either, personal preference	Razor gives sharper line; trimmer gives softer fade
Beard length	Trimmer with guard	Guards set consistent length across the face
Eyebrow tidying	Spoolie + scissors + tweezers	Do not use a razor near the brow

A trimmer without a guard run directly on skin gives approximately a 0.5 mm stubble. A cartridge razor on the same area gives a clean shave. These are different tools for different intentions.

Take-aways

1. Patchy beard density in the early 20s often improves by 25-28, but not always: choose a style that works at current density.
2. Short stubble at 3-5 mm with a clean neck line is the most forgiving option for most men.
3. The neck line sits at two fingers above the Adam's apple: do not take it higher.
4. Face-shape matching has one goal: approximate an oval face by adding length or width where it is missing.
5. Eyebrow work means beneath the brow only. Never reshape the top arch.

"The three beard shapes every man should know are the full beard, the short boxed beard, and stubble , and the right one for you depends entirely on your face shape. A round face needs length at the chin, not width at the cheeks."

Matty Conrad, Victory Barber & Brand (GQ, 2024)

What's next

- **Section (this week):** Grooming kit show-and-tell. Bring all your tools. Peer feedback on beard lines, eyebrow status, and three swaps you will make.
- **Lecture 2:** Fragrance notes, hands, nails, and antiperspirant.
- **Reading:** Beard, brows, fragrance, hands , required before section.
- **HW 3 (Strength program and nutrition plan):** Due this week.